- *Interest* is defined as the stakeholder's level of active engagement in the project.

  The chief data or information officer in the company holds a lot of power over the long-term future of the data mesh initiative. Therefore, the CDO/CIO might voice considerable interest and be willing to support the data mesh approach after it has been proven to work. However, unless you are that person (or the CEO), you can't expect their active involvement at this stage. Thus, stakeholder interest at this stage is low!

- *Attitude* is defined as the expected type of engagement in the project: supporting, resisting, or remaining neutral toward it.

  This criterion goes beyond the apparent feeling of positivity or negativity toward your initiative. For example, someone may feel positive about a data mesh per se but compete with you for resources, because they may be implementing a noncompatible solution.

With those criteria in mind, you position each Messflix data mesh stakeholder's power and interest on a scale and indicate their attitude toward your project by assigning each a color. You end up with the matrix presented in figure 3.3.